Chimera user guide

Process-based instructions for Chimera, updated 2026-10-14 against commit `6641162`. Screenshots for changed authoring, assessment, playback, and export controls were refreshed for this update; the capture records identify earlier images retained for unchanged controls. Captures use the isolated user-guide demonstration workspace and made no live AI requests or use of credentials. Historical source/recovery context is documented in the recovery record.

How to use this guide

Each task has its own **Step / Action / Result / Control image** table. Click a control image to open the full-size screenshot. Screenshots show the real Chimera interface in Light appearance, using an isolated demonstration project. Course names and sample content will differ in your workspace. Browser file pickers, download prompts, and confirmation dialogs vary by browser and operating system; screenshots show the Chimera controls that open them.

The source has changed since the original capability review: Word export, reference upload, enhancement submission, generated-media candidate review, comments, and Chimera storyboard archives now have interface controls. Their presence does not certify a configured AI provider or compatibility with every LMS. Example proposals, candidates, and job statuses in these images are documentation fixtures; no live AI request was made for this guide.

Prerequisite: Start the backend and frontend using the README setup instructions, then open `http://localhost:5173`. Keep both services running while authoring. LibreOffice is needed for rendered PowerPoint slide previews. AI tasks require a configured connection through **Settings > AI connection** or server environment settings. Shared-installation changes require an administrator; see AI connection.

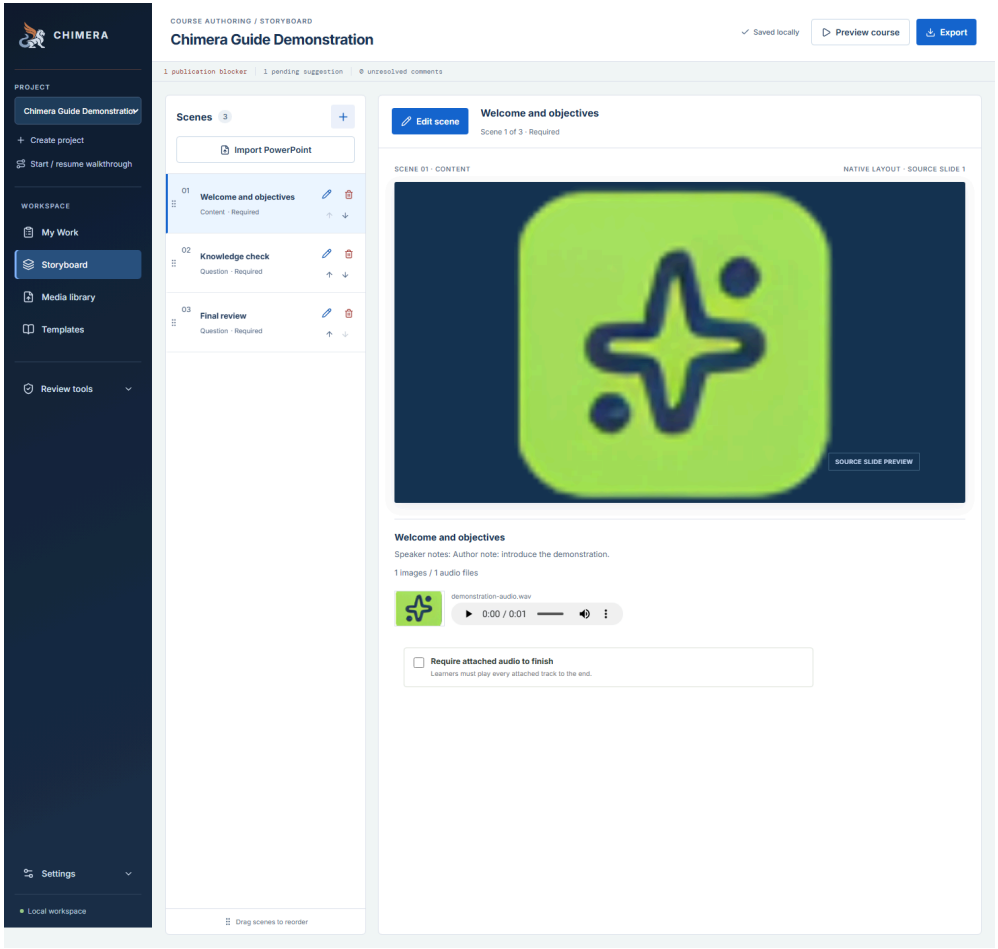
My Work opens after normal launch/sign-in and refresh. It is first in the workspace menu. Select a project row to open its authoring workspace, choose New Project to create one, or Resume authoring to return to the remembered project. Direct authenticated review links retain their review destination.

Working convention: Select the intended project and scene before editing. Use the task's Save/Create/Accept control and wait for completion. Merely typing into a form does not save it. If a revision-conflict message appears, reload the project, inspect the latest values, and reapply the intended change. Do not assume unsaved form text will survive a reload.

Optional interactive help is available under **Review tools > Guided review > All functionality walkthroughs**. Search the catalog and start the task you want to practice. The sidebar resumes your last selected walkthrough. Action steps wait for confirmed saves/downloads; review steps use Next. Escape pauses without clearing an open draft. Progress is browser-local and separate for each task/project; completing a walkthrough does not certify readiness. Restore/deletion confirmations and provider submissions remain your decisions.

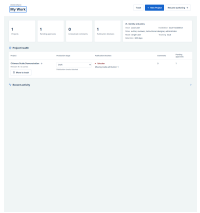
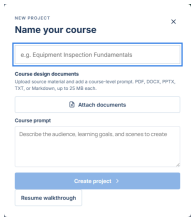
Processes

1. Manage projects and workspace
2. Import and author scenes
3. Manage templates
4. Manage imported media and accessibility
5. Author assessments
6. Import references and request enhancement
7. Review enhancement proposals
8. Generate and approve media
9. Play and comment on the storyboard
10. Validate course readiness
11. Export course deliverables
12. Back up and restore
13. Review project health

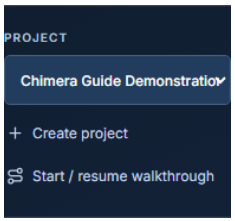

CHIMERA
PROJECT
Chimera Guide Demonstration
Create project
Start / resume walkthrough
WORKSPACE
My Work
Storyboard
Media library
Templates
Review tools
Settings
Local workspace
COURSE AUTHORING / STORYBOARD
Chimera Guide Demonstration
Saved locally
Preview course
Export
1 publication blocker
1 pending suggestion
0 unresolved comments
Scenes 3
Import PowerPoint
01 Welcome and objectives
Content · Required
02 Knowledge check
Question · Required
03 Final review
Question · Required
Drag scenes to reorder
Edit scene
Welcome and objectives
Scene 1 of 3 · Required
SCENE 01 · CONTENT
NATIVE LAYOUT · SOURCE SLIDE 1
SOURCE SLIDE PREVIEW
Welcome and objectives
Speaker notes: Author note: introduce the demonstration.
1 images / 1 audio files
demonstration-audio.wav
0:00 / 0:01
Require attached audio to finish
Learners must play every attached track to the end.

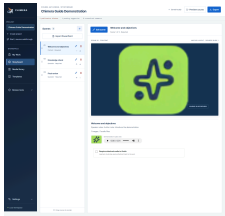
1. Manage projects and workspace

Create a project

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Click **New Project** on My Work, or **Create project** in the sidebar.	The course-name dialog opens. Cancelling keeps your current workspace.	
2	Enter a **Course name**, then click **Create project**.	A new empty project becomes active in Storyboard authoring, with production stage Draft.	

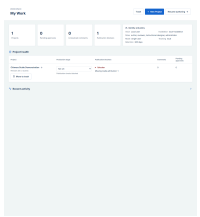
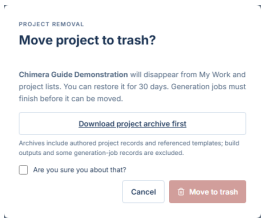
Switch projects

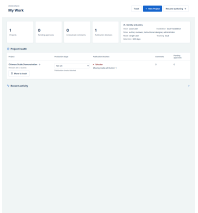
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open the **PROJECT** selector and choose the desired course.	The selected storyboard and project media load.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Check the course title above the workspace before continuing.	Subsequent edits apply to the intended project.	

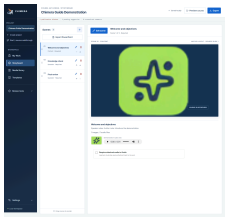
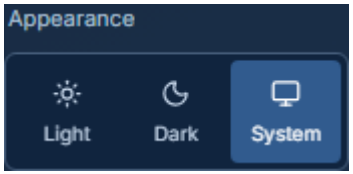
Move a project to Trash and restore it

Project owners can move a project to Trash from its row in **My Work**. Projects remain recoverable for 30 days; opening Trash removes expired entries. Projects with queued or running generation jobs must wait until those jobs finish. In shared installations, administrators can also manage project trash.

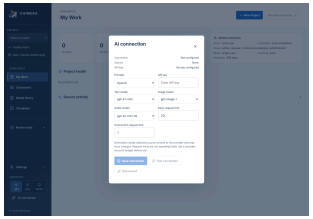
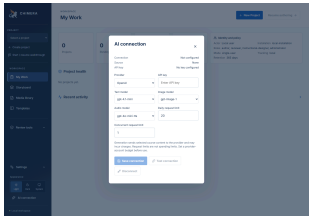
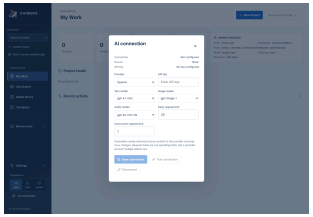
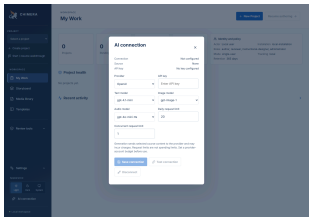
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In **My Work**, choose **Move to trash** for the project. Optionally download its project archive first.	The confirmation explains the 30-day recovery period and archive exclusions.	
2	Select **Are you sure you about that?**, then confirm **Move to trash**.	The project disappears from active lists and authoring. If it was open, Chimera switches to another active project or an empty workspace.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Open **Trash** in My Work and choose **Restore** before the recovery date.	The project and its files return to the active workspace.	

Change appearance

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Settings** at the bottom of the sidebar.	Appearance options become available.	
2	Choose **Light**, **Dark**, or **System**.	The preference is applied and remembered in this browser.	

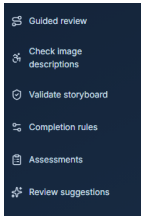
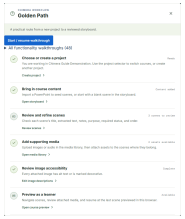
Configure AI

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Settings > AI connection**.	Connection status appears; shared-installation non-admins see a read-only view.	
2	Choose approved models, enter the API key, and set request limits. Click **Save connection**.	The key is stored in the server's OS credential store and cleared from the form. Saving fails closed when secure storage is unavailable.	
3	Click **Test connection** after saving.	A models-list request checks the credential without sending course content or generating media. Model access and costs still depend on the provider account.	
4	To disable AI, click **Disconnect** and confirm.	The saved key is deleted and environment fallback is disabled. Running requests may finish; queued jobs against changed settings require resubmission.	

Request limits are not spending limits. Set a provider-account budget and confirm organisational data-use approval before enabling generation. See AI connection for credential-store provisioning and operational requirements.

Follow the guided workflow

For an interactive first-scene walkthrough, choose **Start / resume walkthrough** in the sidebar or in Guided review. The guide highlights the relevant control and advances after a confirmed project/scene save. Existing projects begin at scene creation. **Escape** or **Pause guide** hides the guide without discarding the open form; use **Resume walkthrough** inside that form to continue. Skipping a step ends the walkthrough without marking it complete. Restarting creates new practice content; it does not reset the project. See the implementation and verification record.

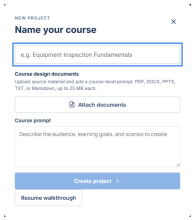
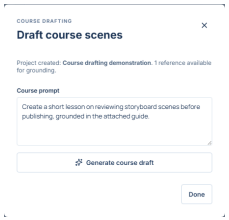
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Expand **Review tools** and click **Guided review**.	The Golden Path checklist opens.	
2	Read a step and use its action, such as **Review scenes**, **Open media library**, or **Run validation**.	Chimera opens that task; unavailable steps depend on project content.	

2. Import and author scenes

Scene creation and edits are saved locally. History snapshots are maintained by the application; there is no general history browser or restore-history button documented in this interface.

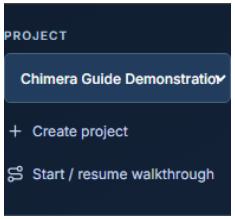
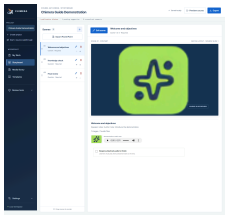
Draft a course with AI

Configure **Settings > AI connection** first. The course prompt generates text and structured questions; it does not create attached images or audio. Review generated facts and questions against your source documents.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Create project**, enter the Course name, and use **Attach course design documents** to select the references that should ground the draft. Enter a **Course prompt** describing objectives, audience, sequence, and desired questions, then create the project.	The project is created and the Draft course scenes review opens.	
2	Review the references and brief, then choose **Generate course draft**.	A proposed scene list appears. Generation does not add it to the storyboard.	
3	Inspect titles, learner text, narration, production notes, and any question answers/feedback/scoring. Edit or deselect scenes as needed, then choose **Add selected scenes**.	Selected scenes are saved after the storyboard revision check. Use the question editor for further question changes.	

Import a PowerPoint storyboard

Importing another deck updates the project from that deck. Download a Chimera storyboard first if the current authored work must be retained independently. Captured animation XML does not guarantee equivalent playback.

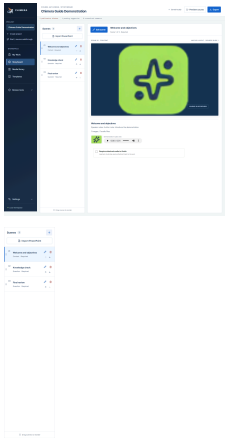
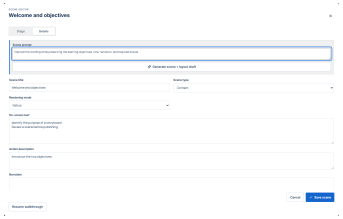
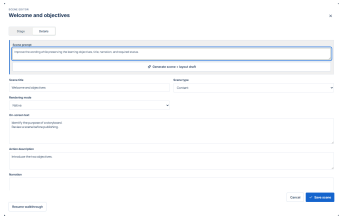
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select the project, then click **Import PowerPoint** above the scene list.	The file picker opens.	 
2	Choose a `.pptx` file and wait for processing.	Scenes, extracted content, and supported media appear; slide rendering may report a LibreOffice warning.	
3	Select each imported scene and inspect its text, notes, media, and preview.	You can identify extraction or rendering issues before publishing.	

Create a scene

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Click the **+** control labeled **Add scene**.	The New scene dialog opens.	
2	Enter **Scene title**, select **Scene type** and **Scene layout**, and enter **On-screen text**. Set directions, notes, and **Required scene** as needed.	The new scene is prepared in the form.	
3	Click **Create scene**.	The scene is appended and saved.	

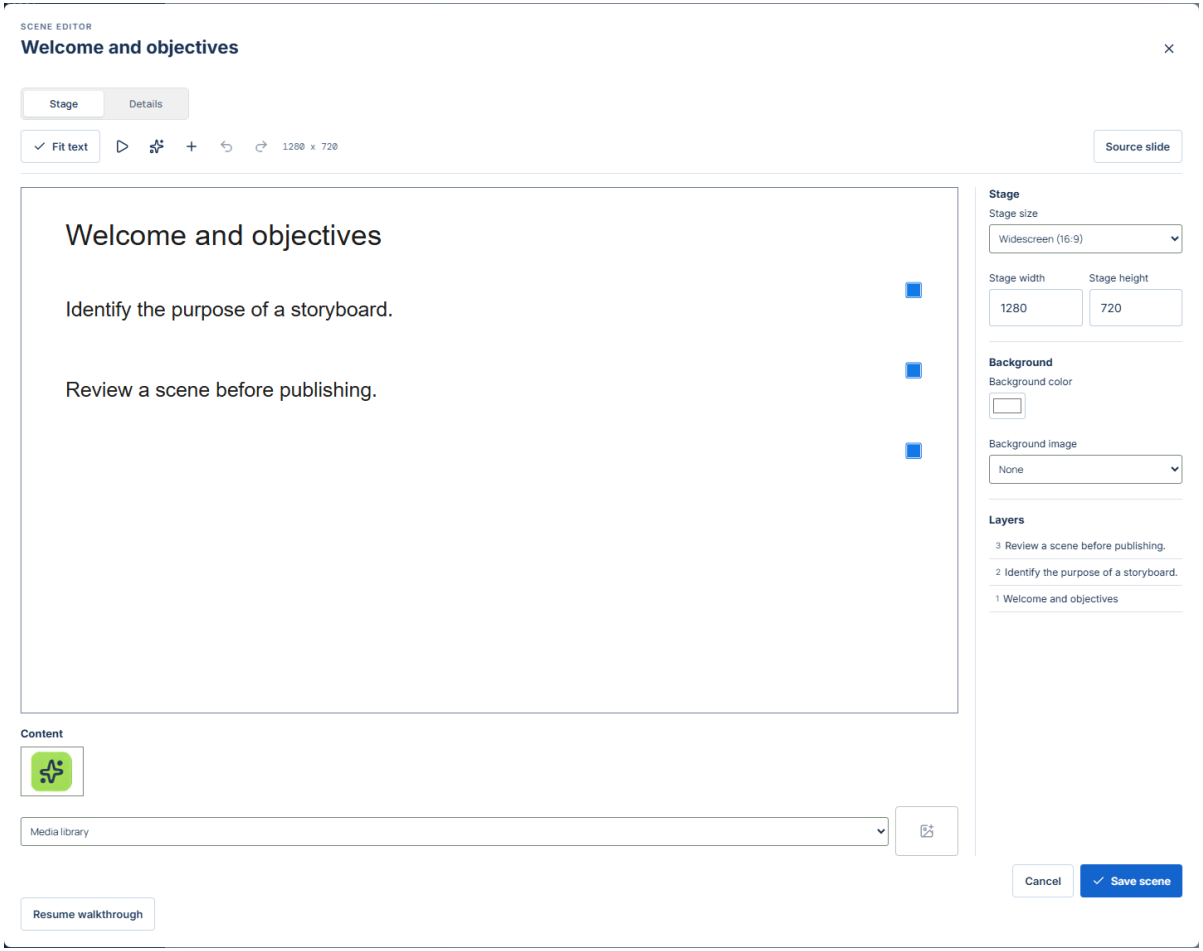
Edit scene content and settings

The **Edit scene** dialog combines scene details and canvas authoring. On-screen text is learner content; action descriptions and speaker notes are authoring material. Inspect playback and exports rather than assuming changes to extracted text redraw an imported slide image.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select a scene, then click **Edit scene** or its pencil icon.	The unified scene editor opens; choose Details to edit scene metadata.	
2	In **Details**, update the title, type, layout, on-screen text, action description, speaker notes, or required status. Choose **Stage** to edit the visual layout in the same dialog.	Both sections share one draft and one save action.	
3	Click **Save scene**; use **Cancel** to discard edits from either section.	Saved changes update the storyboard and its revision.	

Edit text and images on the Stage

Open **Edit scene**, then choose **Stage**. The canvas editor saves an editable layout; it does not paint over the flattened PowerPoint preview. Canvas edits to an imported slide use Hybrid rendering so the edited layers, rather than an unchanged flattened image, are shown.



1. For an older imported scene, choose **Extract source layout** to recover positions and inherited artwork from the retained PPTX. This preserves scene IDs, notes, questions, review threads, existing assets, and authored text. The extracted layout remains inactive until **Save scene**. Cancelling keeps the extracted data but does not change playback.
2. Double-click a text box, or focus it and press Enter, to edit its text directly. The **Text** field also edits the selected box. Drag boxes to move them, use resize handles, or enter exact position and size in the properties panel. Text resize handles preserve the box's current aspect ratio; image resize handles allow freeform sizing. Arrow keys move the focused element; Shift changes the step from one to ten slide-space units.
3. Drag a thumbnail from **Content** onto the Stage. Clicking the thumbnail adds it without dragging. The media-library selector can add other project images. Selecting an image exposes replacement and crop-reset controls.

4. Use **Layers** to select overlapping or inherited content. Master and layout artwork starts locked; unlock it before editing. Toolbar controls add text, undo/redo, duplicate/delete elements, and change stacking order. Text properties include size, color, typeface, alignment, bold, and italic.
5. Choose a background color or project image in the properties panel. Imported picture backgrounds and supported inherited master/layout images are available as project assets. **Source slide**, when available, temporarily shows the original flattened rendering for comparison.
6. Choose **Save scene**, then check **Preview course**. The saved canvas replaces the source preview in authoring, preview, and both SCORM profiles. **Cancel** discards unsaved canvas changes.

New imports capture editable text, images, common PowerPoint shapes, line connectors, custom freeform geometry, rotation, cropping, slide dimensions, inherited graphics, and solid/picture backgrounds. Byte-identical images are shared as one Media library asset while every source placement stays separate on the canvas. Most extracted shapes can be moved, resized, rotated, layered, locked, or deleted like other canvas elements; text inside a shape remains separately editable. The original preview remains available for comparison. Less-common preset geometry, gradients, group rotation, mixed text formatting, bullets, and some inherited styles may be approximated and are listed under **Import limitations**; charts and SmartArt remain unsupported objects. This is not full PowerPoint-equivalent editing.

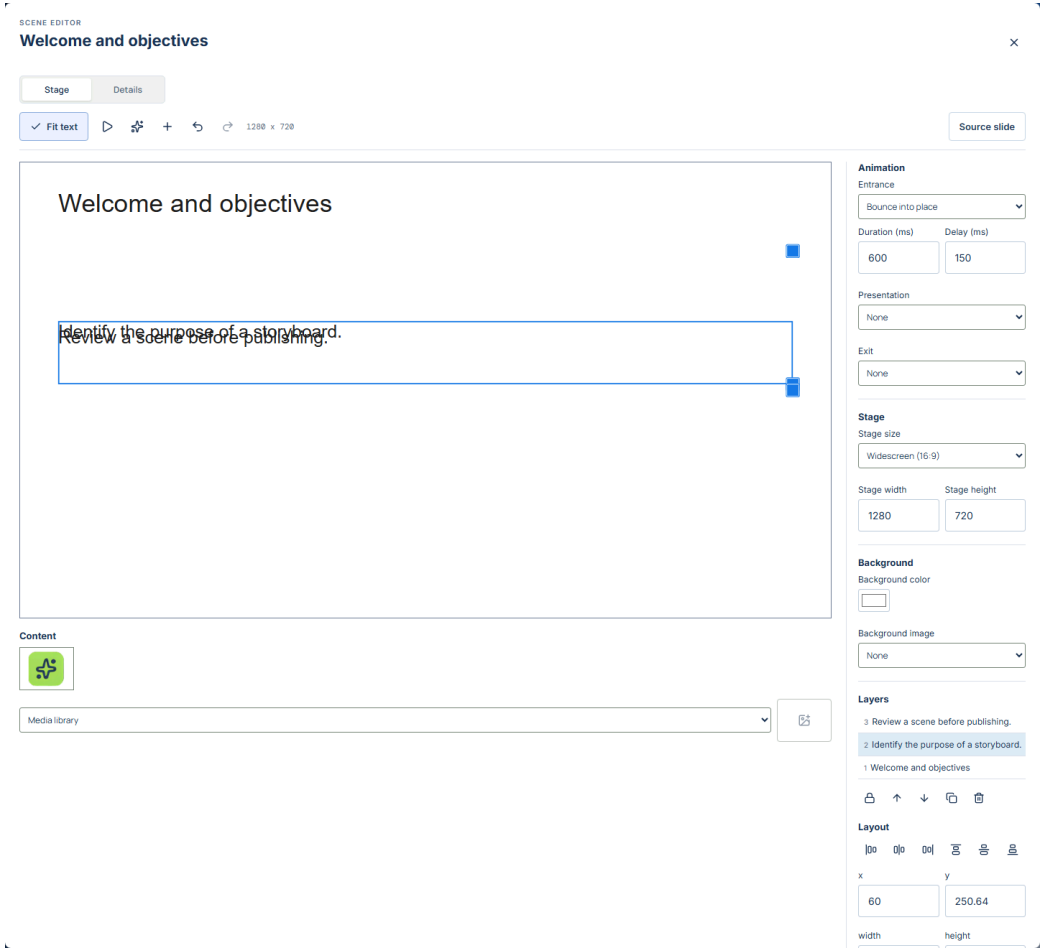
For a scene with an enabled visual layout, edits to **On-screen text** in the original metadata dialog also update the corresponding visual text boxes. Title and On-screen text changes are synchronized with matching visual text boxes when you save. Inspect the Stage before saving; manually composed text and custom placements still need review.

Fit Stage Text

AI scene drafts are measured in the browser before review. If text overflows, Chimera first grows an unlocked, unrotated text box downward into available space without moving its origin or other elements. If necessary it reduces the font size, stopping at 18 px (or the original size if already smaller). Text and animation settings are preserved. Locked text is reported rather than changed.

For an existing scene, select **Edit scene > Stage > Fit text**. The change is undoable and remains unsaved until **Save scene**. The command includes current On-screen text edits. If text still does not fit, the editor identifies it and blocks saving an enabled visual layout until the box or content is corrected. Fidelity-only scenes are not subject to this visual-layout save check.

This is browser-measured overflow checking, not certification of visual quality. Inspect the Stage for existing overlaps, contrast, motion bounds, and reading order. Installed fonts can differ between the authoring and playback machines; recheck representative exported courses on their intended devices. Direct API updates do not run browser measurements.



Animate Stage Content

Text, images, and shapes on an enabled visual Stage support three animation phases. These settings are editable scene data, not production notes, and run in the editor's motion preview, course Preview, SCORM 2004, SCORM 1.2, and standalone packages.

1. Open **Edit scene > Stage** and select a text, image, or shape element.
2. In the **Animation** inspector choose an **Entrance**, **Presentation**, or **Exit** effect and set its duration and delay. Use **None** to disable a phase.
3. For text that dances into place, use the toolbar's **Stagger text entrances** command. It applies a 600 ms bounce entrance to each unlocked text block, adding 150 ms delay per block in element order. It includes the current On-screen text and leaves final positions unchanged.

4. Select **Preview animations** to play the current unsaved timeline. Select it again to replay, or **Stop animation preview** to return to static editing. Changing an element also returns to editing. Generating or previewing does not save the scene.
5. Choose **Save scene** and inspect **Preview course** before exporting. Previously downloaded packages must be exported again.

Supported effects:

Phase	Effects	Timing
Entrance	Fade, slide up, slide from left, zoom, bounce into place	Delay from scene entry; final position remains unchanged.
Presentation	Pulse, sway, highlight	Delay after the entrance ends, or from scene entry if no entrance. Repeats 1-5 times.
Exit	Fade out, slide down, slide to left, shrink out	Absolute scene time, after entrance and presentation finish. Not a transition triggered by Next or Previous.

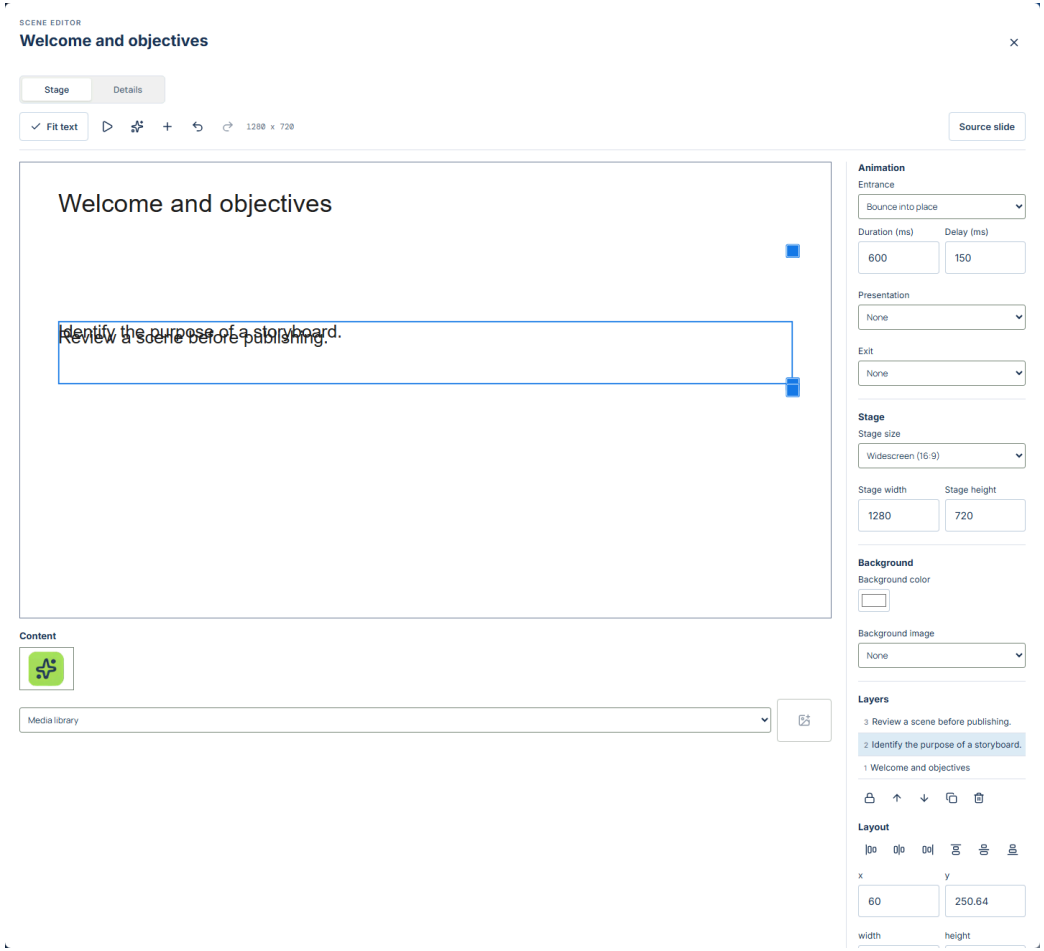
Durations are 100-5,000 ms; delays are 0-60,000 ms. Exited elements stay visually hidden until scene re-entry or **Stop motion**. Keep important instructions visible unless the course intentionally requires their removal. Navigation is not delayed by animation. Effects restart when the learner re-enters a scene, not when an assessment result changes. Existing elements without animation settings remain static. Animations do not alter geometry, assessment answers, attempts, or completion rules.

Learners can select **Stop motion** to immediately restore static content, and **Play motion** to restart. In Chimera Preview, **Replay motion** restarts the current scene's effects in one click without navigating, changing assessment answers, or saving the scene. Entrance and finite presentation effects settle into the final static layout, so use Replay when reviewing effects that finished before you could inspect them. Preview hides its separate page heading when the Stage already contains the same title; the accessible scene name remains available. The system's reduced-motion preference suppresses effects and reveals content immediately, including when the preference changes during playback. The assessment question component itself stays interactive and static; animation controls apply to text, image, and shape elements. Arbitrary motion paths, custom scripts/keyframes, click-triggered reveal sequences, audio synchronization, and PowerPoint animation playback are not implemented by these presets.

Scene AI drafting receives the supported animation schema. For example, enter:

> Animate the title and each On-screen text block into its final Stage position when the scene begins. Use staggered bounce entrances, 600 ms each, with 150 ms additional delay per block. Add one gentle sway after each entrance. Keep all final positions unchanged and do not add exits. Configure the visualLayout element animations, not just production notes.

AI drafting returns a complete scene/layout draft, so inspect both its content and animation settings before saving. Model quality still requires review; the schema validates supported effects and timing, not the instructional appropriateness of motion.



Revise a scene with AI

Open **Edit scene > Details**, enter a **Scene prompt**, and choose **Generate scene + layout draft**. The request includes the current editor values, including unsaved text and title, the course sequence and completion rules, and relevant reference excerpts. The returned layout replaces the editor draft; inspect the Stage, optional status, notes, narration, question data, and animation settings before choosing **Save scene**. **Cancel** discards the editor draft.

Scene drafting composes text on a 1280 × 720 Stage. It does not preserve every visual object or create images, audio, arbitrary scripts, or custom interactions. Attached assets are sent as metadata references rather than media binaries. A production action described in notes is not automatically implemented. Browser text fitting runs before review; unresolved overflow must be corrected before saving an enabled visual layout. Preservation and factual quality still need author review.

Example prompt: “Clarify the three procedure steps without adding facts. Preserve the current title, required status, narration, and question scoring. Animate each text block with a staggered bounce entrance and leave it visible afterward.”

Jump directly to another scene

In **Preview course**, open **Contents** and choose a scene by number and title. The list marks the current and visited scenes. Jumping preserves assessment answers and audio-completion state, and only the selected scene becomes visited. Exported SCORM players provide a **Contents** selector with the same scene sequence.

The reviewer form follows Light and Dark appearance for labels, fields, thread text, and controls. Its contrast is qualified in both modes.

Reorder scenes

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Locate the scene in the scene list. Drag its row to the target position, or use its up/down arrow buttons.	The sequence is changed and saved.	
2	Select the moved scene and verify its position.	The course sequence reflects the intended order.	

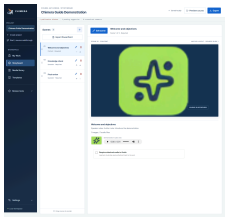
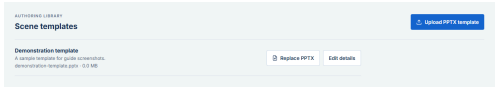
Delete a scene

Download a Chimera storyboard before deletion when you need an accessible recovery copy. History storage does not imply a visible one-click undo control.

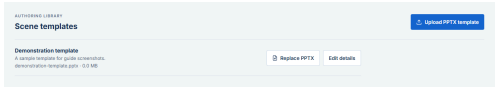
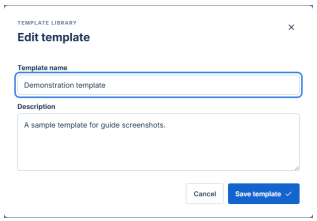
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select the trash icon beside the scene to remove.	A confirmation describes the deletion and relevant consequences.	
2	Read the confirmation and confirm only if the correct scene is named; otherwise cancel.	The scene is removed after confirmation; the previous storyboard is retained in history.	

3. Manage templates

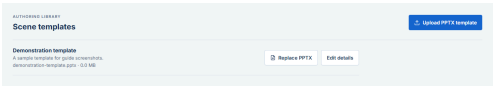
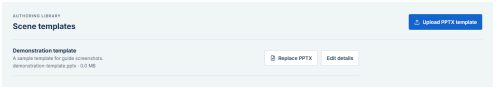
Upload a scene template

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Templates** in the sidebar.	The template library opens.	
2	Click **Upload PPTX template** and select a `.pptx` file, up to 50 MB.	The uploaded template appears in the library.	

Edit template details

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In **Templates**, click **Edit details** for the intended template.	The template editor opens.	
2	Change **Template name** and **Description**, then click **Save template**.	The library metadata is updated.	

Replace a template source deck

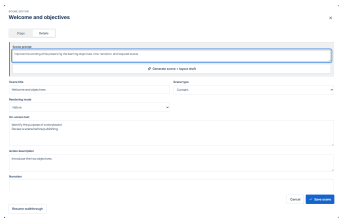
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In **Templates**, locate the correct template and click **Replace PPTX**.	The file picker opens for that template.	
2	Choose the revised `.pptx` file and wait for completion.	The template source is replaced; inspect affected scenes before publishing.	

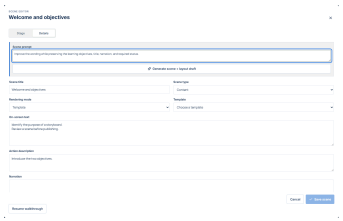
Assign a template to a scene

Scene layout chooses how the scene is rendered:

- **Fidelity** keeps the rendered source slide.
- **Hybrid** uses the extracted slide background and editable slide layers.
- **Native** uses a clean white canvas with the scene's learner-facing text.
- **Template** uses the selected PPTX's first-slide design and master/layout artwork, replacing its sample text with the scene content.

PowerPoint effects that Chimera cannot represent may be approximated or omitted; compare the result with the source slide before publishing.

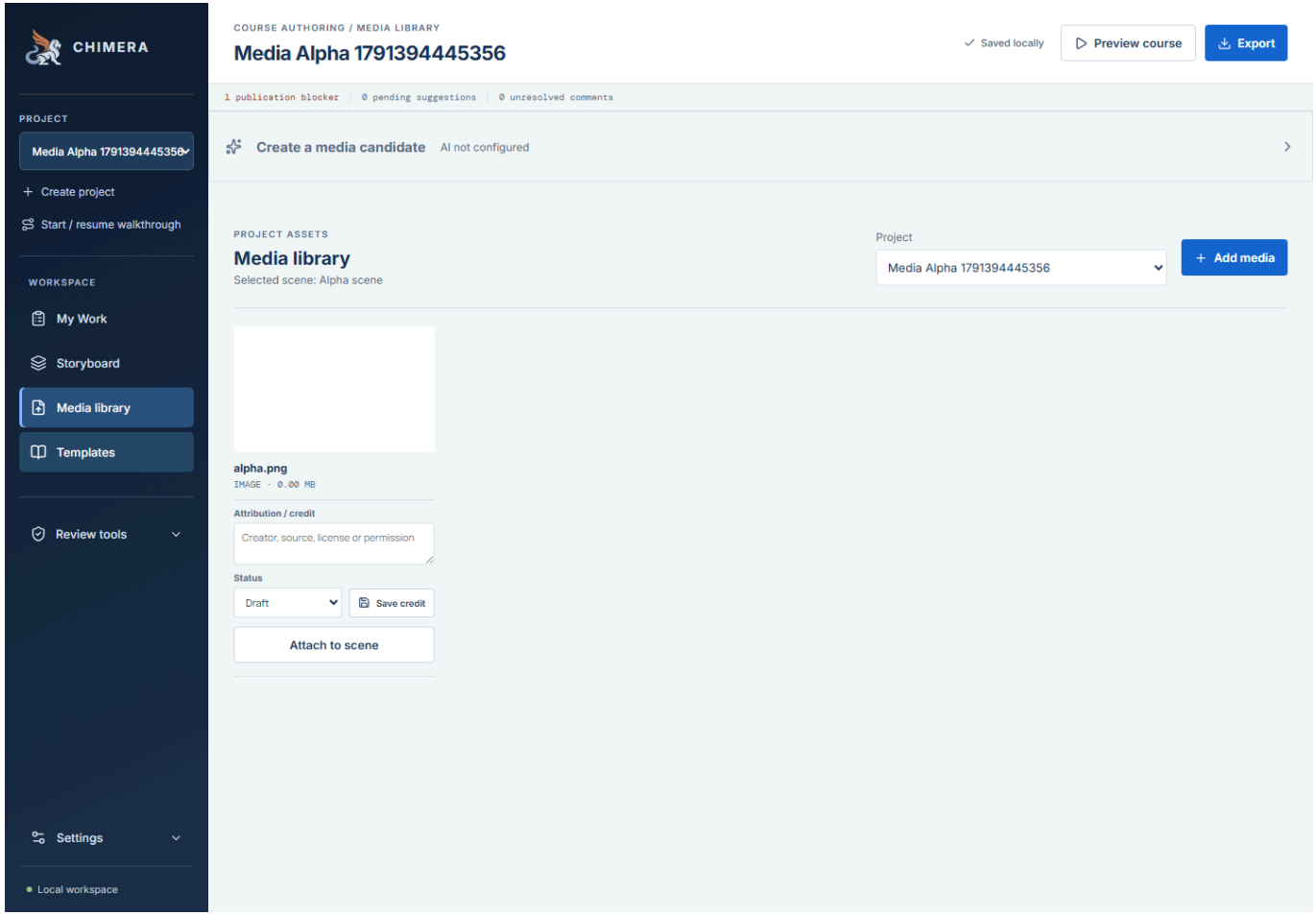
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open the scene editor and set **Scene layout** to **Template**.	A Template selector appears.	

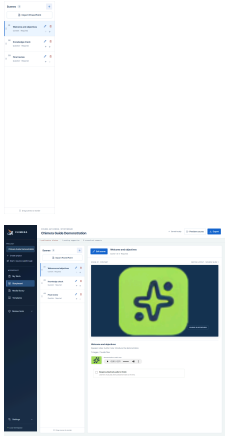
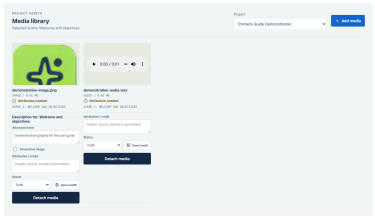
Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Choose a template, then click **Save scene** or **Create scene**.	The scene background and editable design layers update to the selected template.	

4. Manage imported media and accessibility

The current upload interface accepts images and audio, up to 100 MB per file. Images: JPG, PNG, GIF, WebP. Audio: MP3, M4A, AAC, WAV, OGG. Video import, a shared media library across projects, and explicit course-wide placement are not exposed by these controls.

Add external media



Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select the intended scene in **Storyboard**, then open **Media library**.	The media view identifies the selected scene.	
2	Select the intended project using **Project** (defaults to the current project), then click **Add media** and choose a supported file.	The asset is added to the selected project library. Adding media does not by itself attach it.	

Create a media candidate

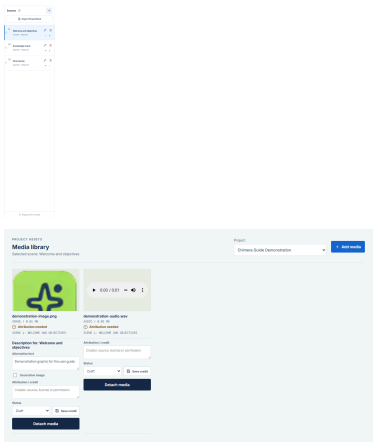
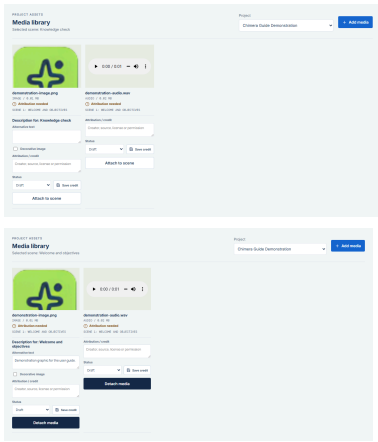
Configure AI through **Settings > AI connection** before generating candidates. In shared deployments, an installation administrator manages the connection. See AI connection for credential storage, connection testing, limits, and data handling.

Create a media candidate starts collapsed. Select its heading to expand it. When the server-side AI connection is not configured, its heading is greyed and generation controls are disabled. If connection status cannot be loaded or your role does not permit generation, controls also remain disabled. Configuration availability does not guarantee that a provider is reachable or supports a particular model. Existing candidates can still be approved or rejected without a configured AI connection; regeneration requires the connection.

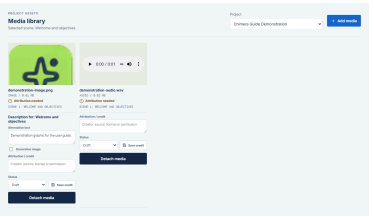
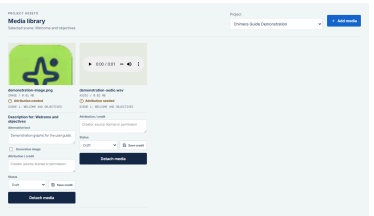
The Media Library project selector defaults to the current project. Selecting another project opens that project's media library and makes it the current project; media files are not copied between projects.

Attach or detach scene media

The screenshot shows an attached example and its Detach media button. The same control reads Attach to scene when the asset is not attached.

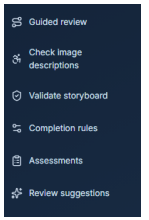
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select the target scene in **Storyboard**, return to **Media library**, and locate the asset.	The selected scene determines the attachment target.	
2	Click **Attach to scene**. For an attached asset, click **Detach media** to remove the scene association.	The scene reference changes; detaching does not delete the library asset.	

Record media attribution

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In a media card, fill **Attribution / credit** with creator, source, and license or permission information.	Attribution text is prepared.	
2	Choose **Draft** while unfinished or **Complete** when verified, then click **Save credit**.	The attribution status is saved. Production validation reports pending image attribution as a warning so export can proceed; verify the credit before release.	

Describe scene images

You can enter **Alternative text** or select **Decorative image** directly in an image's Media library card beside its attribution. The description heading identifies the selected scene. For an attached image, **Save credit** also saves the scene description. For an unattached image, **Attach to scene** saves the attachment, description and credit; saving credit alone does not attach the image or persist its pending description. Descriptions are scene-specific, so editing one scene does not overwrite another scene's description of the same image.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Review tools** → **Check image descriptions**.	Attached images are grouped by scene.	

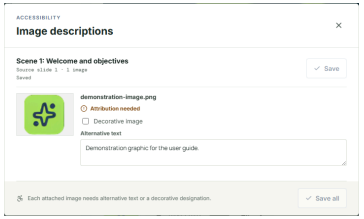
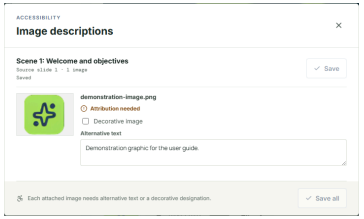
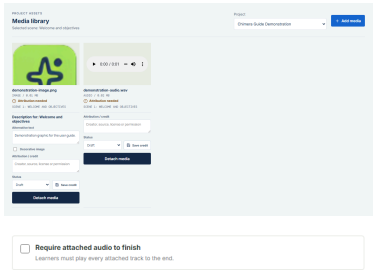
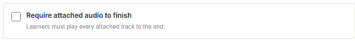
Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Enter **Alternative text** describing the image information, or select **Decorative image** when appropriate.	Each image has a description or explicit decorative designation.	
3	Click **Save** for a scene or **Save all** for all edited scenes. Closing the panel also saves pending changes.	Saved and unsaved states are visible. A failed save leaves the panel open with your draft intact.	

Image groups identify the current storyboard scene number and title, plus the source slide when available. Media library items list every scene that uses the image or audio.

A green **Ready for production** check means the media loaded, its attribution is saved as Complete with credit text, and any image description or decorative designation is saved. In the Media library, images must meet the description requirement in every referencing scene; unattached media is not marked ready. Amber indicators identify pending saves, missing descriptions or attribution, and unavailable media. Image attribution marked **Attribution Pending** is a warning that does not block export, but the credit must be verified before release. Incomplete audio attribution remains a blocking production error. This is media readiness, not visual approval or whole-course release approval; run Production validation before release.

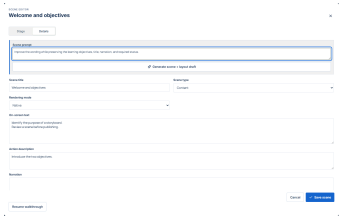
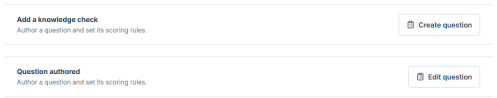
Require audio completion

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Attach audio to the scene, then return to its storyboard view.	The required-audio checkbox is available below the scene.	
2	Select **Require attached audio to finish**.	Learners must finish every attached track for that audio requirement.	

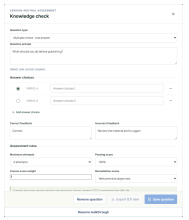
5. Author assessments

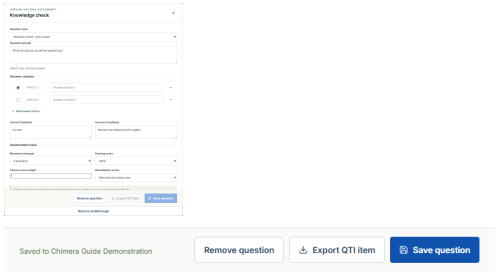
A **Question** scene contains one authored question. An **Assessment** is a named, ordered collection of Question scenes. Start each question-authoring task with a scene whose **Scene type** is **Question**; older courses using the Assessment scene type load automatically as Question scenes. Set that type in Edit scene and save. Select **Create question** for a new question or **Edit question** for an existing one. The question editor supports seven types. Changing types replaces the type-specific question structure in the form; save only after checking the new content.

Open or create an assessment question

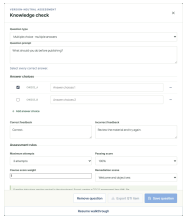
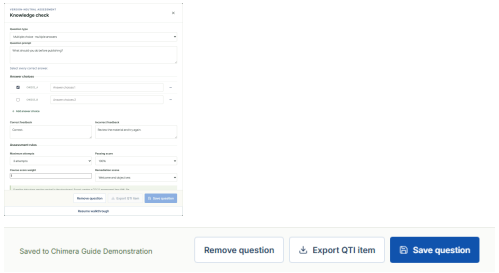
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Edit the scene, choose **Question** under **Scene type**, and save.	The scene displays the question-authoring section.	
2	Click **Create question** or **Edit question** above the Stage.	The question editor opens.	

Author a single-choice question

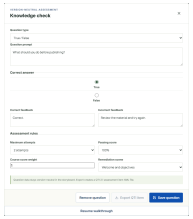
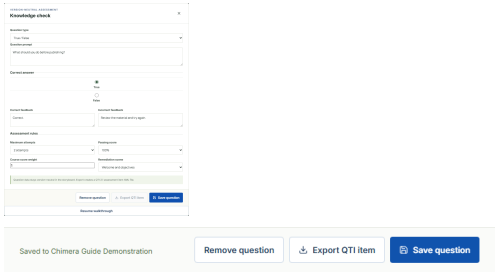
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Multiple choice · one answer**, enter the **Question prompt** and answer text, and mark exactly one answer as correct. Use **Add answer choice** or the minus buttons as needed.	The question content and correct response are defined.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

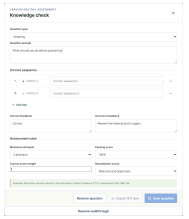
Author a multiple-correct question

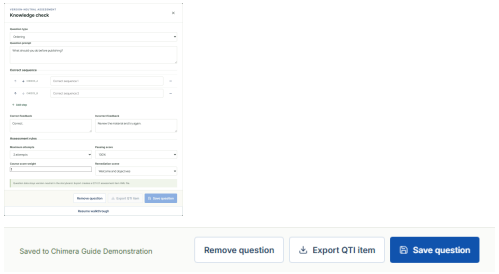
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Multiple choice · multiple answers**, enter the prompt and answer choices, and select the checkbox for every correct answer.	The question content and correct response are defined.	
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

Author a true/false question

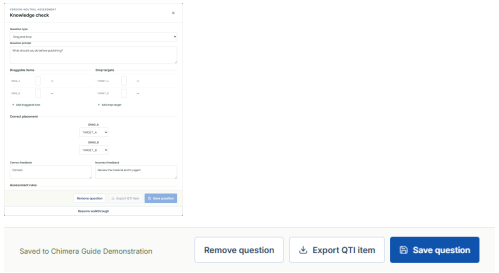
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **True / False**, enter the statement as the prompt, and select **True** or **False** under Correct answer.	The question content and correct response are defined.	
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

Author an ordering question

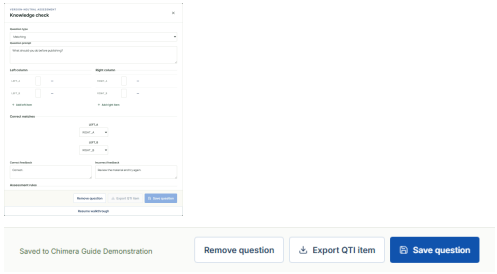
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Ordering**, enter the prompt and steps, and use the earlier/later arrows to establish the **Correct sequence**. Use **Add step** as needed.	The question content and correct response are defined.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

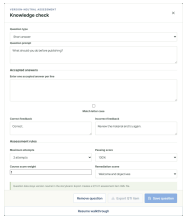
Author a drag-and-drop question

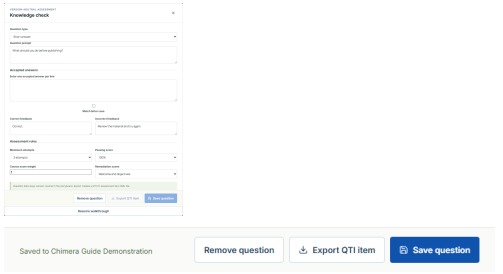
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Drag and drop**, enter the prompt, draggable items, and drop targets, then choose each correct placement. Use distinct targets for the intended matches.	The question content and correct response are defined.	
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

Author a matching question

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Matching**, enter the prompt and left/right items, then select each correct match.	The question content and correct response are defined.	
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

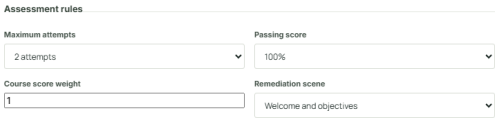
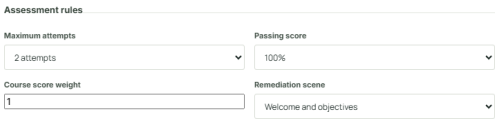
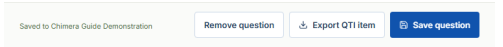
Author a short-answer question

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Short answer**, enter the prompt, and enter one accepted answer per line. Select **Match letter case** only when capitalization must match.	The question content and correct response are defined.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

Configure question scoring and remediation

Current question scoring is binary: 0% or 100%. Course score weights affect the aggregate course score; they do not create partial credit within a question.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open the question editor and scroll to **Assessment rules**.	Question-level settings are visible.	
2	Set **Maximum attempts**, **Passing score**, **Course score weight**, and an optional **Remediation scene**.	Attempts, scoring contribution, and review destination are specified.	
3	Click **Save question**.	The question and its rules are saved.	

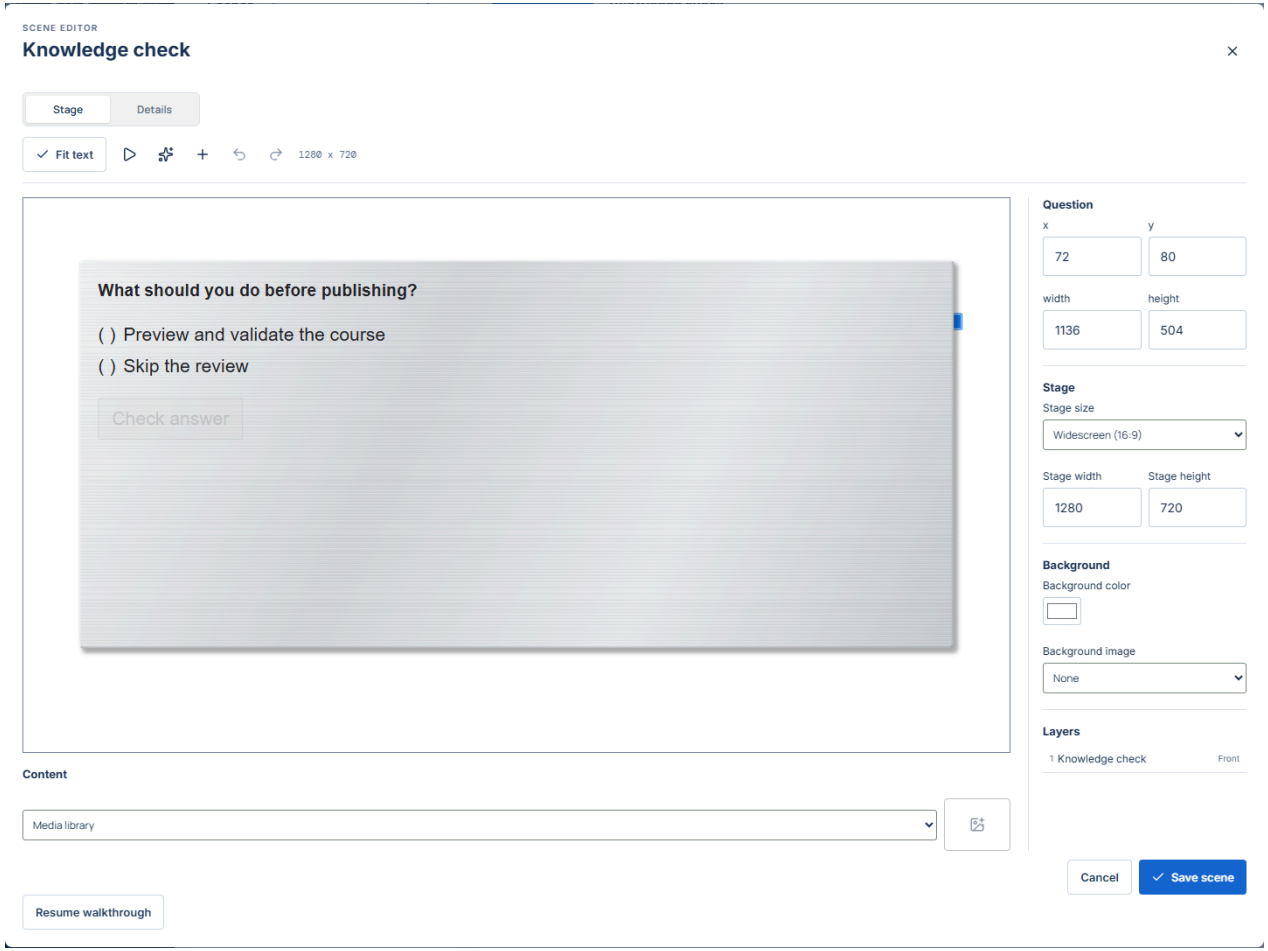
Place a question on the Stage

An authored assessment appears as a question component on the scene Stage, not as a separate block beneath it. The component reads the existing question data; its prompt, choices, answer key, feedback, and scoring are not copied into ordinary text elements.

1. Use **Create question** or **Edit question** above the scene preview to author the question.
2. Open **Edit scene > Stage**. The question and learner choices appear on the canvas; correct answers are not revealed there.
3. Drag or resize the question component, or use the **Question** inspector's position and size fields. The region must remain inside the Stage. Shrinking the Stage keeps the saved question region within its new bounds.
4. Choose **Save scene**. Placement is saved separately from the question, and remains when the question is edited. Use the question editor to change question content; the Stage component is not an independent copy.
5. Check **Preview course**. The on-stage controls support all seven question types with their existing attempts, scoring, feedback, and remediation behavior.

Existing assessments without placement data receive a default origin matching the scene's title element, and the redundant Stage title is omitted. Explicitly saved positions remain in use. SCORM and standalone exports use the same authored origin and no longer duplicate the question below the Stage. The question panel grows with its content instead of adding an internal scrollbar; the page can scroll for long content. Learner question text uses a compact 16 px base and 20 px prompt, with native form inputs and reduced spacing. Authoring uses a non-interactive representation; use Preview to answer the question. QTI remains question-data-only and does not include Stage placement.

Submitting an answer opens a feedback modal with the explanation, score, attempts, and a Review lesson action when remediation is configured. Close feedback or Escape returns to the question without closing Preview or changing the attempt count. View feedback reopens the last submitted result without submitting another answer. A changed, unsubmitted answer must be checked again before feedback is available. Correct answers and exhausted attempts remain locked according to the existing scoring rules. The platinum question panel retains its brushed finish, rounded corners, and lower-right shadow; modal feedback uses explicit high-contrast success/error colors in either theme.



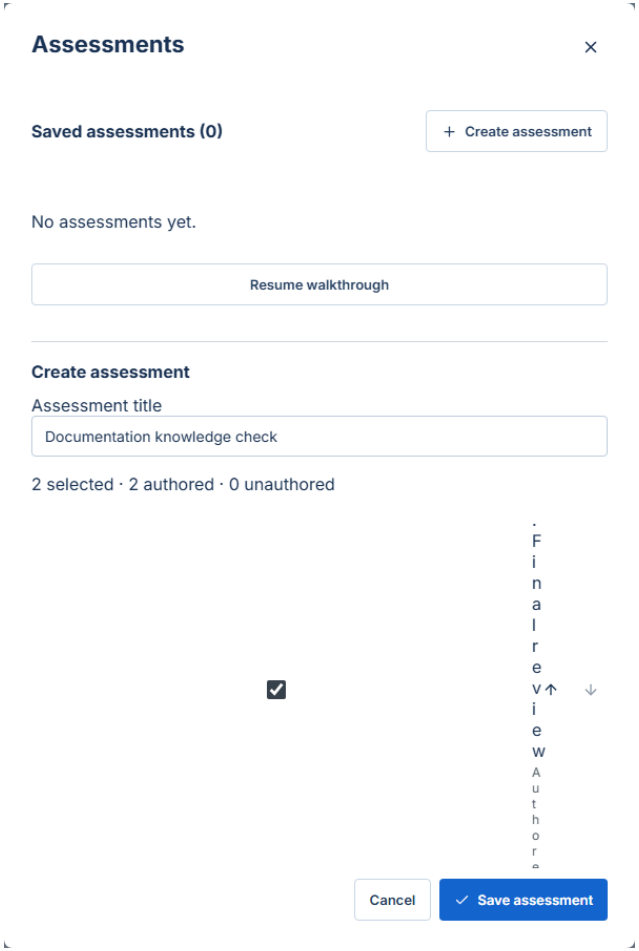
Create and edit Assessments

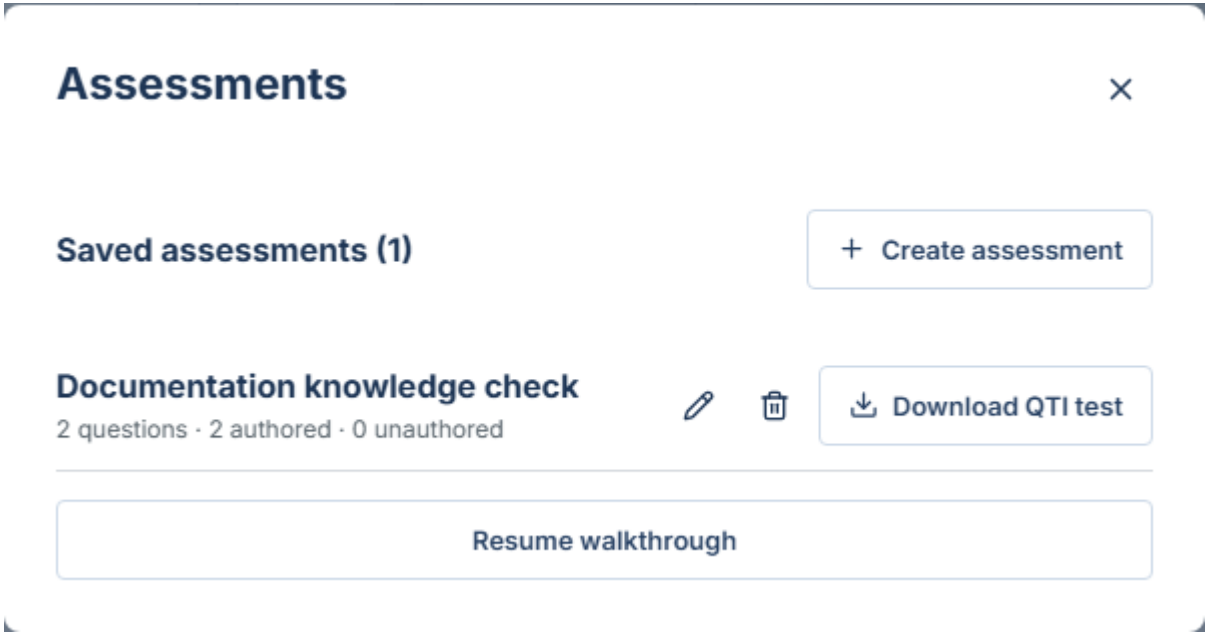
Choose **Question** as the scene type when creating a question scene. Older courses that use the `assessment` scene type load as Question scenes automatically. Use **Create question** or **Edit question** above the selected scene Stage to author its prompt, answers, feedback, and scoring.

An Assessment is a named, ordered collection of Question scenes. Open **Review tools** → **Assessments**, choose **Create assessment**, enter a title, select questions, and use the arrow controls to set their order. Choose **Save assessment** to persist the collection. Empty collections can be saved as drafts. Use the saved collection's **Edit** control to change its title, membership, or order.

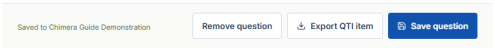
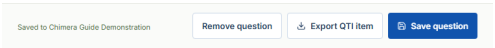
Download QTI test exports the collection's authored questions in the selected order; at least two authored questions are required. Preview shows each collection's answered count and weighted score. Grouping does not change course completion settings or count a question twice in the course score.

Deleting an Assessment retains its Question scenes. Deleting a Question scene removes its membership from all Assessments. Remove a Question from its collections before changing its scene type. If another author saves first, reload the latest storyboard and review your retained draft before saving again. Collections are included in storyboard JSON and project backups.

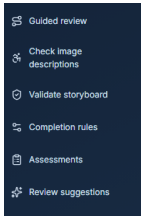
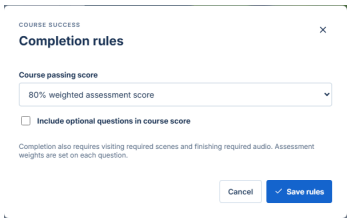
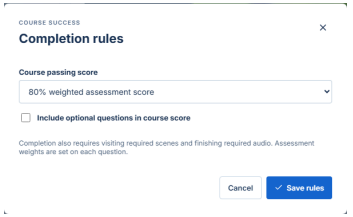




Remove an assessment question

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open the existing question and click **Remove question**.	A removal confirmation appears.	
2	Confirm removal if intended.	The question is removed from the scene; the scene remains.	

Set course completion rules

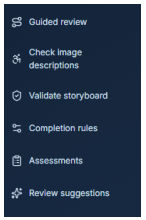
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Review tools → Completion rules**.	Course-level scoring controls open.	
2	Select **Course passing score** and whether to **Include optional questions in course score**.	The aggregate scoring policy is prepared.	
3	Click **Save rules**.	The policy is saved. Required scene visits and required audio also contribute to completion.	

6. Import references and request enhancement

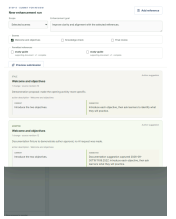
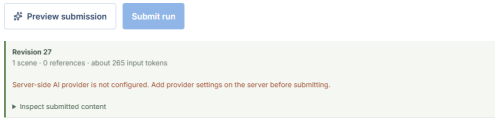
AI submission requires an administrator to configure the server-side provider. Without it, Preview submission remains useful, but Submit run is disabled. This guide does not claim that an AI service was contacted or its output verified.

Import a Study Guide or supporting reference

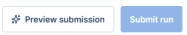
Failed or incomplete extraction disables selection. The current form does not provide full resource classification, version-management, or scene-mapping editors.

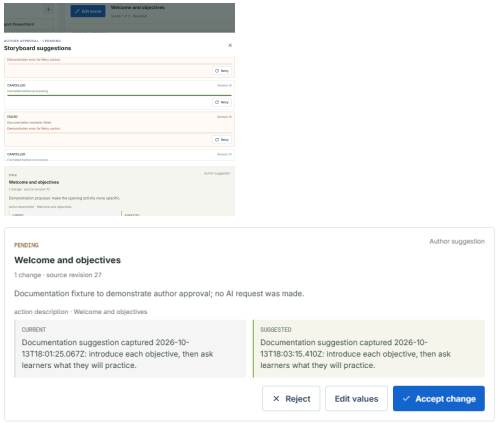
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Review tools** → **Review suggestions**.	Storyboard suggestions opens with the New enhancement run form.	
2	Click **Add reference** and select PDF, DOCX, PPTX, TXT, or MD, up to 25 MB.	Chimera imports the resource and attempts text extraction.	
3	Check the extraction status under **Permitted references**. Select the resource only if extraction is complete.	Selected references become eligible for the enhancement request.	

Select enhancement scope and inspect the submission

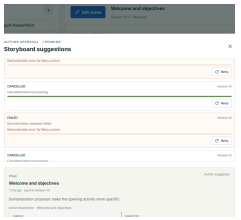
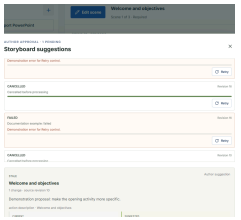
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Whole course** or **Selected scenes** under **Scope**; for selected scenes, check the required scene boxes.	The enhancement target is defined.	
2	Enter an **Enhancement goal** and check the **Permitted references** to include.	The run is limited to the chosen content and references.	
3	Click **Preview submission**, then expand **Inspect submitted content**.	You can inspect the payload, source revision, counts, estimated input tokens, and any available cost estimate.	

Submit an enhancement run

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Complete and inspect the submission preview. Resolve the provider-not-configured message if present.	You know what will be sent and whether submission is available.	
2	Click **Submit run** when enabled.	An enhancement job is created; it produces proposals rather than directly applying changes.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Review the job status and any reported resource conflicts, then review returned suggestions individually.	You can distinguish completion, failure, and suggestions needing a decision.	

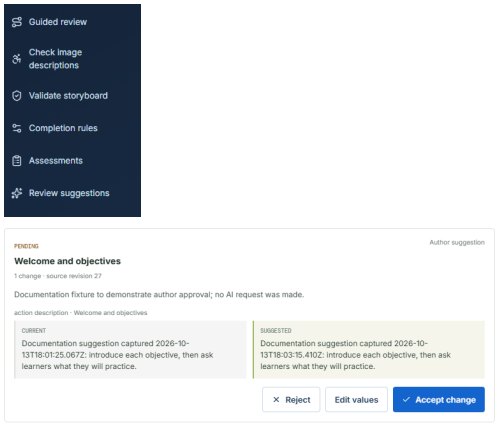
Cancel or retry an enhancement job

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In Storyboard suggestions, find the run under **Enhancement jobs**.	Its status and message are visible.	
2	Click **Cancel** for a queued/running job, or **Retry** for a failed/cancelled job after addressing the cause.	Cancellation is requested or a retry job is started. Neither action approves proposals.	

7. Review enhancement proposals

Accept or reject a suggestion

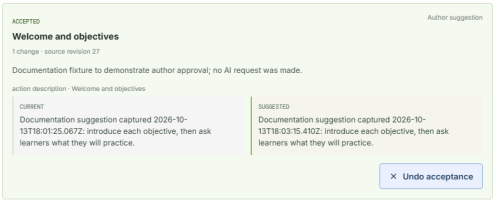
A proposal can contain multiple related changes. Accept change applies that displayed proposal as a group, so review every included change. A source-backed label is not a substitute for checking the source.

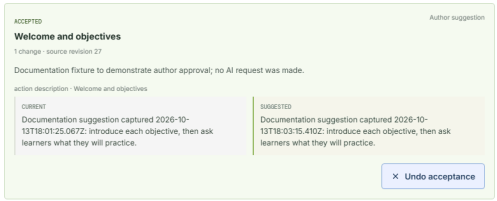
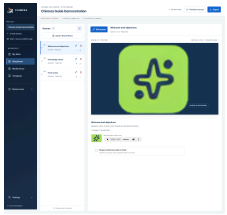
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Review tools** → **Review suggestions** and locate a pending proposal.	The proposal shows its rationale, source revision, and changes.	
2	Compare **Current** and **Suggested** for every included change; inspect citations if provided.	You understand the complete proposal before deciding.	
3	Click **Accept change** to apply the proposal, or **Reject** to leave the storyboard unchanged.	The decision is recorded. A stale/conflicting proposal cannot overwrite newer edits.	

Edit a suggestion before accepting

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	On a pending proposal, click **Edit values**.	Editable suggested-value fields appear.	
2	Revise the suggested values. Structured values are labeled JSON and must remain valid JSON; use **Cancel edit** to discard these form edits.	The displayed proposed content reflects your intended version.	
3	Click **Accept change**.	The edited proposal is applied if valid and current.	

Undo an accepted suggestion

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Locate the accepted proposal and click **Undo acceptance**.	Chimera attempts to restore the captured previous values.	

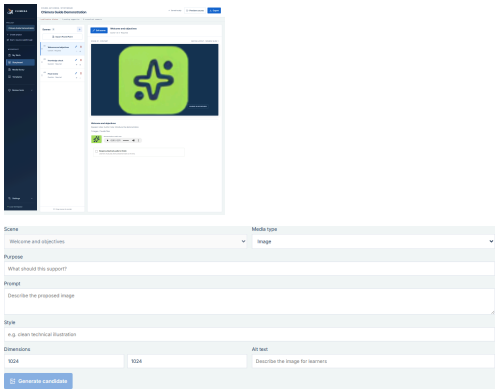
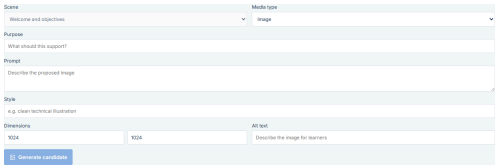
Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Inspect the resulting scene or any conflict message.	Reversal succeeds only when later changes do not prevent a safe restore.	 

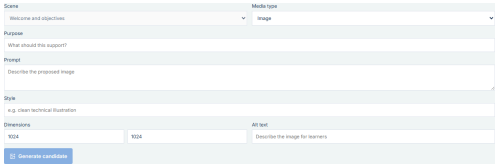
8. Generate and approve media

Select the target project and scene before opening Media library. Create a media candidate starts collapsed; expand its heading to access the form. Without AI configuration or generation permission, the section is greyed and generation/regeneration is disabled. Existing candidates remain reviewable. Approval attaches a candidate to its target scene; choose **Edit scene > Stage** afterward to place supported image assets. A generation-cost preview and full media-job monitor are not provided.

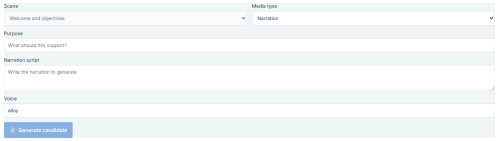
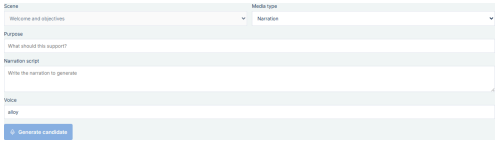
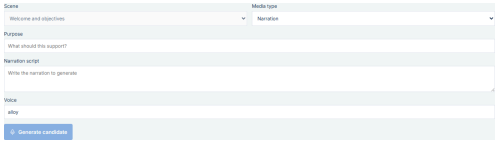
Request an image candidate

The current provider implementation sends the prompt and dimensions to image generation; put essential style directions in Prompt as well. Candidate appearance does not guarantee source or factual accuracy.

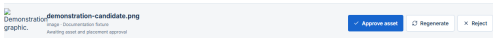
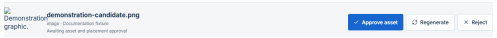
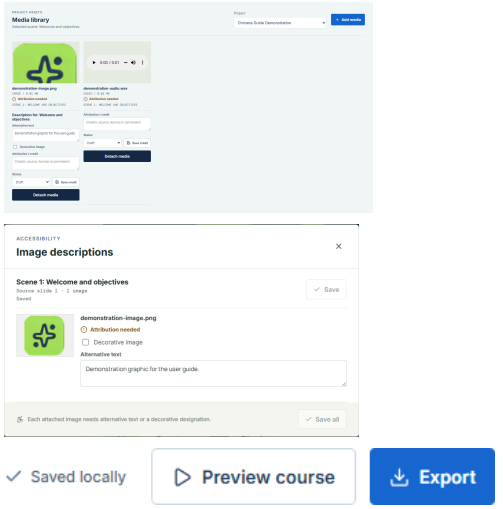
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Media library**, expand **Create a media candidate**, and verify Scene. Set **Media type** to **Image**.	The selected scene is the generation target.	
2	Enter **Purpose**, **Prompt**, optional **Style**, **Dimensions**, and **Alt text**.	The request form describes the candidate. Provider support determines valid dimensions.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Click **Generate candidate** and wait for a candidate or error.	A successful request yields a pending candidate without attaching it to the storyboard.	

Request narration

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In Media library, set **Media type** to **Narration** and verify the target scene.	Narration fields replace image fields.	
2	Enter **Purpose**, **Narration script**, and a provider-supported **Voice**.	The narration request is prepared.	
3	Click **Generate candidate**.	A successful provider run returns an audio candidate for review.	

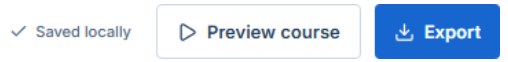
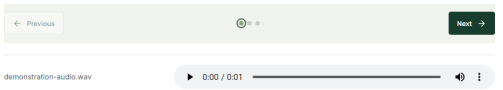
Approve, reject, or regenerate a media candidate

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Inspect the image or listen to the audio under **Candidate review**. Confirm that the selected scene is the intended target.	You review the asset before attachment.	
2	Click **Approve asset** to approve and attach it, **Reject** to discard the candidate from consideration, or **Regenerate** to request another candidate.	Only approval places the candidate into the active project/scene; regeneration may incur provider usage.	
3	After approval, check the asset in the media library, its attribution, accessibility details, and course preview.	The approved asset is reviewed in its actual context.	

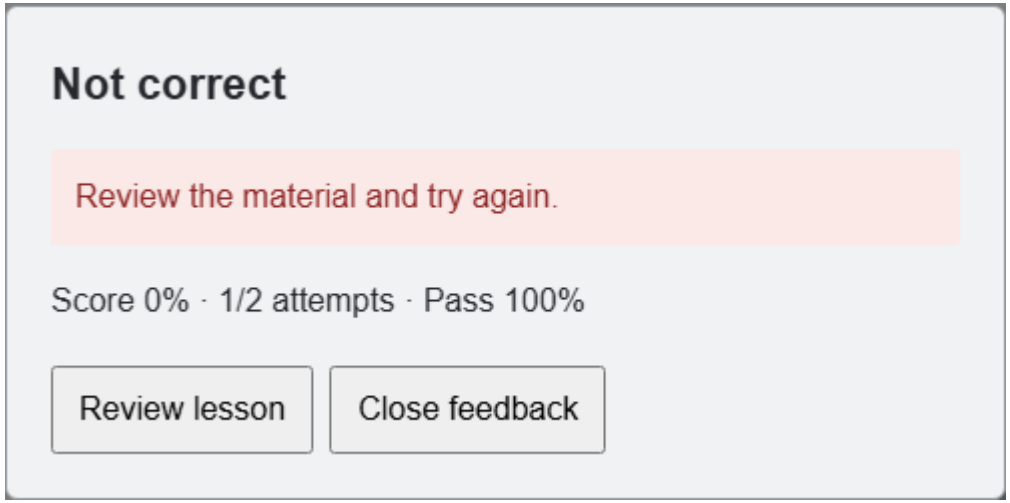
9. Play and comment on the storyboard

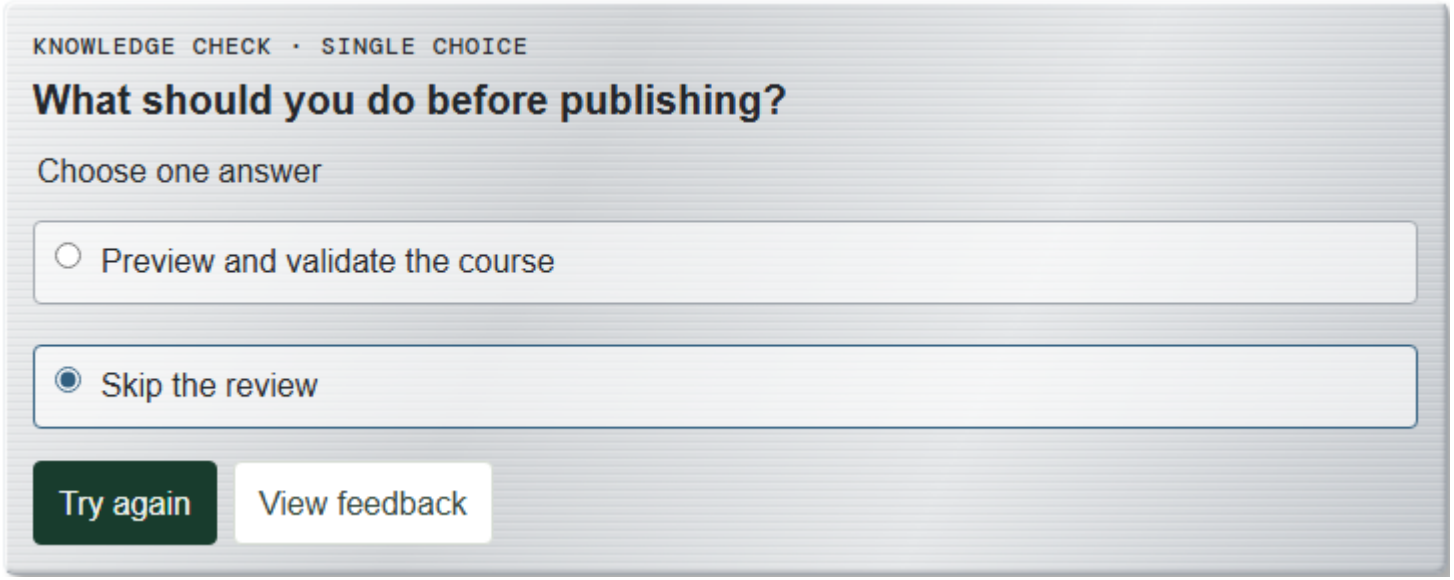
Preview progress is stored in this browser, separately from a learner's LMS session. In-app discussion is available. Hosted authenticated review links are documented in the authentication deployment guide; local guest review and timestamp-entry controls are not available.

Play the storyboard

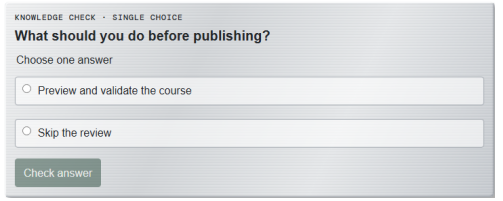
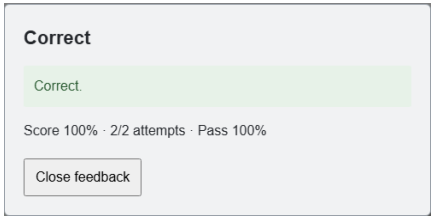
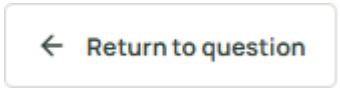
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Click **Preview course** in the top bar.	The playable storyboard opens.	
2	Use **Next**, **Previous**, or a scene navigation dot. Play attached audio with its player controls.	You review scene order, content, and media; required progress updates.	
3	Use **Read slide text** when shown for a rendered imported slide. Click **Exit preview** to return to authoring.	You can inspect extracted text and resume editing.	

After an incorrect answer, close feedback and choose **Try again** to clear the response without using another attempt. Enter a new answer and choose **Check answer** to grade it. You can also change the answer directly; the action then becomes Check answer. Completed or exhausted questions retain their attempt limits.

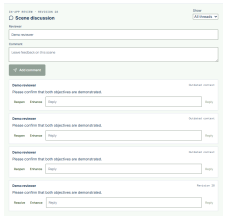

Not correct
Review the material and try again.
Score 0% · 1/2 attempts · Pass 100%
Review lesson
Close feedback


KNOWLEDGE CHECK · SINGLE CHOICE
What should you do before publishing?
Choose one answer
Preview and validate the course
Skip the review
Try again
View feedback

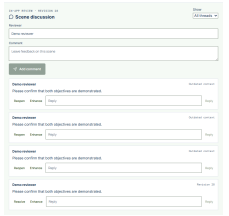
Test an assessment in preview

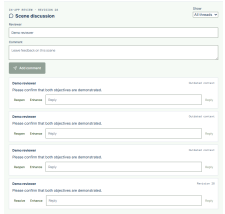
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Navigate to the Question scene. Select an answer, enter text, order items, or match/drag items as appropriate.	A response is prepared.	
2	Click **Check answer**; use **Try again** when offered after an incorrect attempt.	Feedback, score, and attempt count appear. Correct answers or exhausted attempts disable further attempts.	 
3	If **Review lesson** is offered, follow it and use **Return to question** to resume.	The remediation path is exercised.	 

Add a scene comment

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	During preview, navigate to the scene and scroll to **Scene discussion**.	Feedback will be associated with that scene and review revision.	
2	Enter **Reviewer** and **Comment**, then click **Add comment**.	A persistent discussion thread is created.	

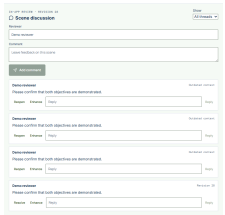
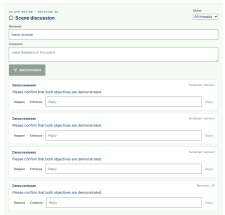
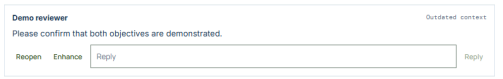
Reply to a comment

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Find the thread in Scene discussion and enter text in its **Reply** field.	A reply is prepared.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Click **Reply** beside the field.	The reply is added to the thread.	

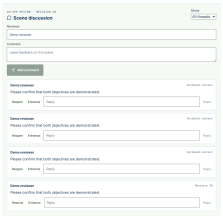
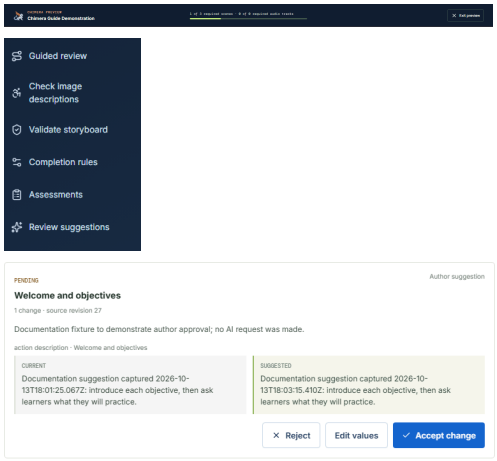
Resolve, reopen, and filter comments

Outdated context means the underlying review context has changed; revisit the current scene before acting on that feedback.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **All threads**, **Unresolved**, or **Outdated** from **Show**.	The discussion list is filtered.	
2	Click **Resolve** on an addressed thread.	The thread is marked resolved.	
3	Choose All threads if necessary, then click **Reopen** to resume discussion.	The thread becomes unresolved again.	

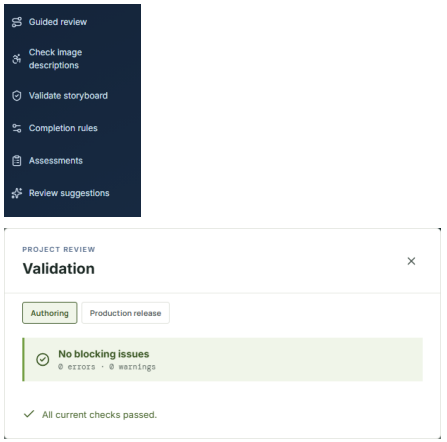
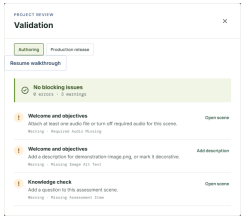
Request enhancement from a comment

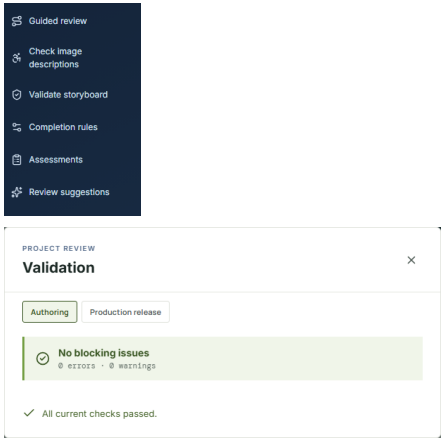
This shortcut submits no reference resources in the current implementation. Use the normal enhancement form when you need selected references or a submission preview.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Read the comment and click **Enhance** on its thread.	Chimera requests enhancement for that scene using the comment as the goal. This action submits directly when the provider is configured.	
2	Exit preview and open **Review tools → Review suggestions** to inspect the job and any proposals.	Suggestions still require explicit approval.	

10. Validate course readiness

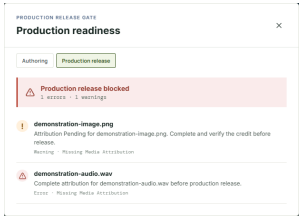
Validate an authoring draft

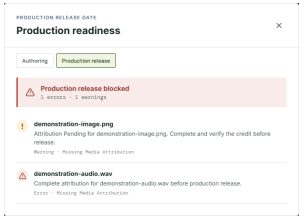
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Review tools** → **Validate storyboard**.	The validation report opens in Authoring mode.	
2	Review errors and warnings. Use **Open scene** or **Add description** where offered.	The relevant editor opens so you can fix the issue.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Save corrections and reopen validation.	A new report reflects the saved storyboard.	

Check production readiness

Passing validation is not certification for every LMS. Pending suggestions and unresolved discussion should be reviewed deliberately; they do not automatically represent published changes.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In validation, click **Production release**.	Chimera runs production checks.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Resolve blocking errors, including missing assets, and inspect warnings such as **Attribution Pending** for images. Reopen the report after changes.	The report shows blocking production errors separately from pending image credits; export can proceed with that warning.	

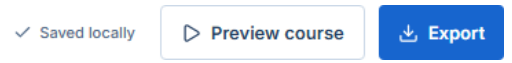
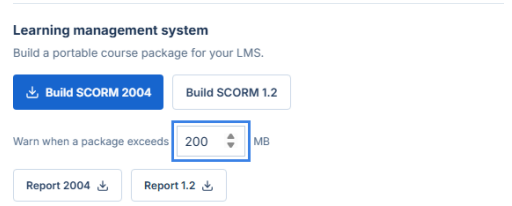
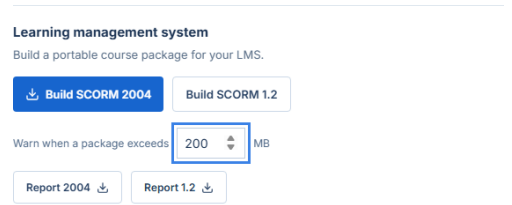
11. Export course deliverables

Open Export for the intended saved project. Export uses saved content, not unsaved dialog edits or pending proposals. Use the SCORM profile supported by your destination LMS. The current SCORM 1.2 test package passed retry, Continue, Start over, and Gradebook score/completion checks in the operator's LMS on 2026-10-14; consult the compatibility checklist for the tested package and evidence limits. This does not qualify every course or LMS configuration.

Build a SCORM package

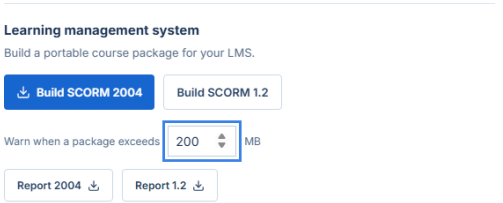
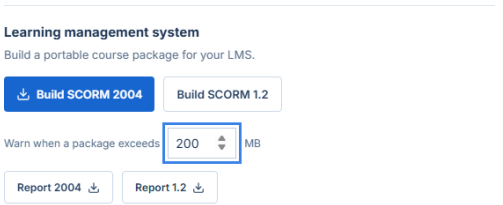
When the LMS returns saved progress, the exported player asks whether to **Continue** at the saved scene or **Start over**. Continue retains answers, attempts, and progress. Start over resets course-owned state and returns to the first scene; it does not create a new LMS attempt or guarantee clearing a previously recorded grade. LMS grading and attempt rules still apply. Closing the course before choosing leaves the saved bookmark unchanged. New launches without saved progress do not show this prompt. Standalone packages have no persistent resume state and are unaffected.

LMS upload controls are outside Chimera and vary by platform. Verify launch, media, completion, score, and resume in the destination LMS.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Click **Export** in the top bar.	The Export course dialog opens.	
2	Choose **Build SCORM 2004** or **Build SCORM 1.2** according to the receiving LMS.	After validation and build, the browser downloads a ZIP, or shows an actionable error.	
3	Keep the ZIP intact and upload it using the receiving LMS's SCORM-package workflow.	The LMS can launch and track the package after its own acceptance checks.	

Set a package-size warning and download build reports

A report may be absent before the first build. Verify its revision/date before treating it as evidence for a newer package.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In Export, change **Warn when a package exceeds** and leave the field to save a valid value.	The warning threshold is saved in MB.	
2	After building the corresponding profile, click **Report 2004** or **Report 1.2**.	The latest available profile build report downloads.	

Export a standalone local course

1. Open **Export** and find **Standalone course**.
2. Select **Download standalone ZIP**. The saved course must pass the same production validation as SCORM exports.
3. Extract the entire ZIP into a folder. Do not run the course from inside the ZIP viewer.
4. Open the extracted `index.html` in a modern browser. Keep its scripts, `assets`, and any `renders` folders together.

The package contains its own player, course data, and media. It does not require Chimera, an LMS, an internet connection, or a local web server. The same directory can also be hosted on a static web server. Do not remove or rearrange packaged files.

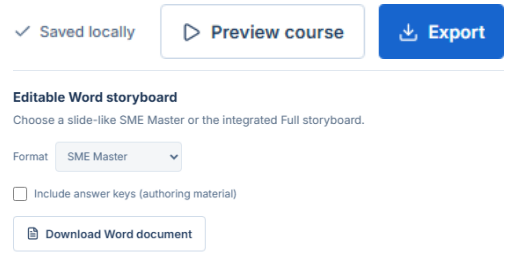
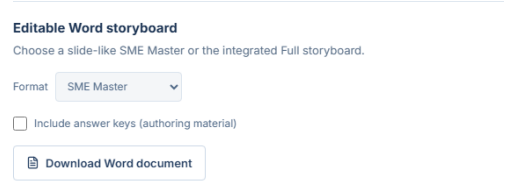
Navigation, visual layouts, attached images/audio, required-audio playback, and assessments use the existing course player. Assessment answers and progress last only while the page is open; reloading or reopening starts a new session. No results are sent to an LMS or saved as learner records. Use SCORM when persistent LMS tracking is required. Answer keys are present in the package, so this format is not appropriate for secure testing. Narration text does not create audio unless an audio file is attached.

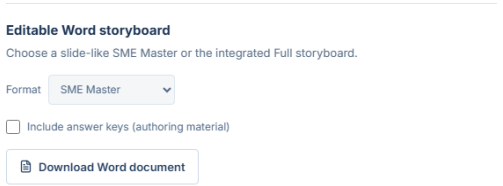
The ZIP includes `README.txt` launch instructions. Its `course-data.js` preloads course data without a browser fetch, allowing direct `file://` launches. `storyboard.json` is the published learner data, not a full authoring backup; speaker notes and production action descriptions are excluded.

Standalone and SCORM exports share the same presentation. Saved visual layouts and source-slide previews are retained. Native scenes with neither an enabled visual layout nor a slide preview use a slide-style title-and-text fallback instead of unframed text. This fallback does not invent a designed layout or change the saved scene. Desktop content uses a 16:9 frame; longer content and narrow screens expand to keep text readable. Previously downloaded packages must be exported again to receive player updates.

Export an editable Word storyboard

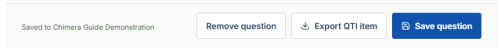
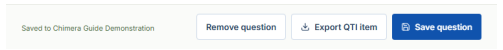
Choose **SME Master** for one editable landscape, slide-like page per scene, or **Full storyboard** for the Multimedia Instructional document with SME pages and detailed scene records. In both formats, attached image thumbnails appear in the corresponding media row with identifying, accessibility, and credit details. Edits made in Word do not synchronize back into Chimera. Word reimport is not exposed by this interface.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Export** and locate **Editable Word storyboard**.	The Word controls are visible.	
2	Choose **SME Master** or **Full storyboard**, then decide whether to **Include answer keys (authoring material)**.	The format and answer-key policy are selected.	

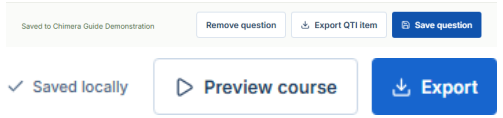
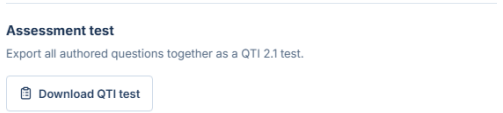
Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Click **Download Word document**, then open the DOCX in Word.	Scene text and tables are editable; images remain images and interactions are documented rather than playable.	

Export one question as QTI

Chimera attempt/retry settings are not equivalent to settings in the receiving assessment system; verify them after import.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open the question editor, complete the question, and click **Save question**.	The current question becomes eligible for item export.	
2	Click **Export QTI item**.	A QTI 2.1 item XML file downloads.	

Export a multi-question QTI test

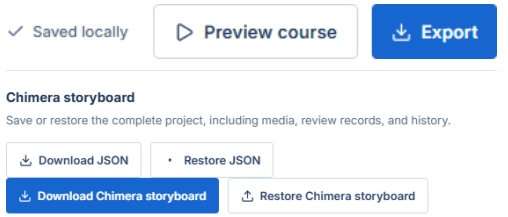
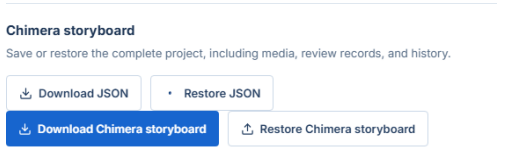
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Save questions in at least two Question scenes, then open **Export**.	The Assessment test section becomes available.	
2	Click **Download QTI test**.	A QTI 2.1 test package containing the authored questions downloads.	

12. Back up and restore

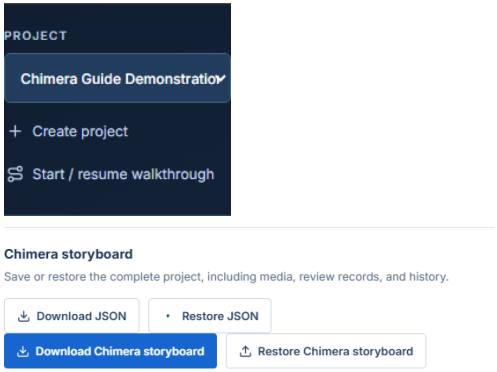
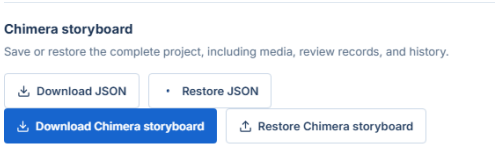
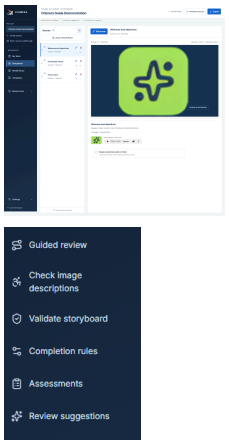
Prefer a Chimera storyboard when preserving the whole project. JSON contains storyboard data and asset references but not media binaries. Restore replaces active project content; select the target carefully and download a current Chimera storyboard first.

Download a Chimera storyboard

Build outputs/reports, media-generation job records, and the generated-candidate index are excluded by the current archive policy. Do not treat the archive as a record of every generation operation.

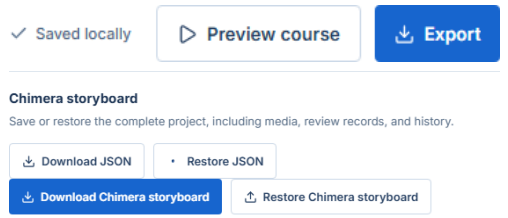
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Export** → **Chimera storyboard**.	Storyboard archive controls are visible.	
2	Click **Download Chimera storyboard** and retain the ZIP.	A project archive includes authored project files, resources, review records, history, and referenced templates according to the archive policy.	

Restore a Chimera storyboard

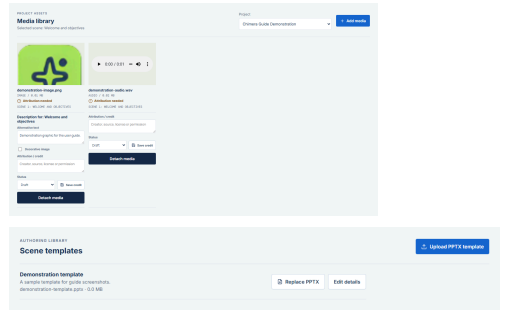
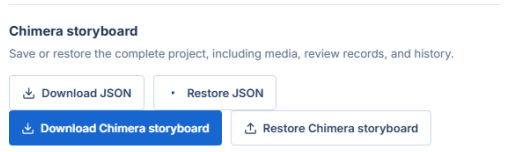
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select the intended destination project and download its current Chimera storyboard.	You have a separate recovery copy.	
2	Click **Restore Chimera storyboard** and select the archive; read and confirm the replacement prompt if intended.	Chimera validates and restores the archive or reports an error.	
3	Inspect scene order, media, references, comments, and validation after restoration.	The restored project can be checked before further authoring or publication.	

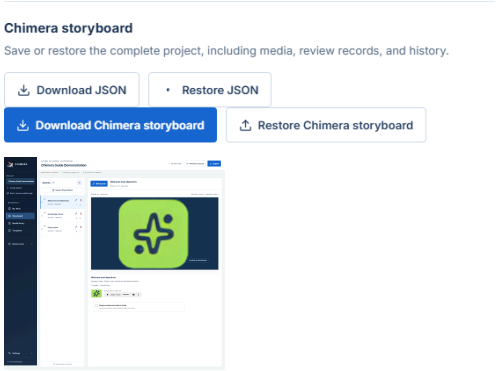
Export storyboard JSON

Use this for structured transfer of storyboard data. It is not a self-contained media backup.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Export** and click **Download JSON**.	The storyboard and asset-reference data download as JSON.	

Restore storyboard JSON

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Verify that referenced assets and templates already exist in the target project.	Required dependencies are available for restoration.	
2	Open **Export** → **Restore JSON**, choose the JSON file, and read the replacement confirmation.	You can confirm or cancel replacement of the active storyboard.	

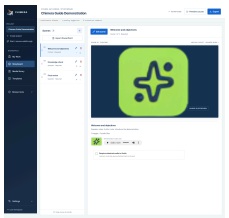
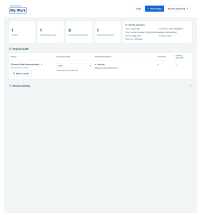
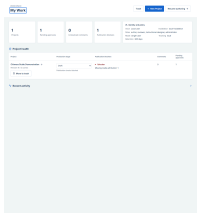
Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Confirm if intended, then inspect the restored storyboard.	Valid JSON replaces storyboard data and preserves the previous storyboard in history; invalid input reports an error.	

13. Review project health

Inspect My Work

My Work is the opening workspace, with identity/policy shown compactly beside the summary counts. Hosted project lists are filtered by access. Production stage is a manually declared workflow label, not validation readiness or approval evidence: new projects start Draft, older projects remain Not set until classified. Authors with project-settings permission can update it without changing the storyboard revision. See My Work.

Project health uses a bounded, keyboard-scrollable area at five or more projects, with sticky desktop headings. Blocker summaries identify types and counts; expand them for individual findings. Recent activity starts collapsed and has its own scroll area when expanded.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Click **My Work** in the sidebar.	My Work fills the main workspace, with sidebar navigation still available.	
2	Review counts, production stages and categorized blockers. Expand blocker findings or **Recent activity** as needed.	You can identify projects that need attention without treating readiness as approval.	
3	Select a project name/row to open that project's Storyboard, or choose **Resume authoring**.	Authoring opens for editable projects; review-only users retain review access.	

Features without a documented user-facing workflow

Do not follow the implementation build plan as if every planned control already exists. The following have no complete workflow in the interface captured here:

- Unauthenticated guest review. Authenticated hosted review links have a separate documented deployment workflow.
- Video upload, caption/transcript authoring, and course-wide/shared media-library controls. Supported image placement is available through **Edit scene > Stage**.
- Full reference-resource classification, authority, version-management, and per-scene mapping editors.
- Word reimport or automatic synchronization of external edits.
- A general history browser and arbitrary revision restore.
- Scene timestamp/asset-anchor entry for comments.
- Generated video and a full media-generation job/cost dashboard.

See the implementation build plan for planned scope. Availability should be checked against the running application, not inferred from that plan.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to do
Projects or libraries do not load	Confirm both local services are running and inspect the displayed error.
A control is disabled	Select a project/scene, complete required fields, or wait for the current operation. AI Submit run also needs server configuration.
PowerPoint imports without a slide image	Check the render warning and LibreOffice availability. Inspect extracted text and media.
Media upload is rejected	Check the supported image/audio extension, file validity, and 100 MB limit.
A reference cannot be selected	Inspect its extraction status. Supply readable text when extraction is incomplete.
A proposal or save reports a revision conflict	Reload the latest project and compare changes before trying again. Preserve unsaved text separately first.
A SCORM build is blocked	Run Production release validation and resolve the listed errors.
A QTI test button is disabled	Save at least two authored questions in the course or selected Assessment, and confirm export permission.
Try again seems to submit the same answer	Re-export packages built before the retry fix. In the current player, close feedback, choose Try again, enter a new response, and choose Check answer. Retry retains used attempts; exhausted questions stay locked.
SCORM does not resume or report grades	Confirm Connected to LMS tracking and launch a learner attempt in a graded SCORM activity using the supported profile. Record any initialization/rejected-call diagnostic and inspect the LMS grading and attempt settings.

Symptom	What to do
Text does not fit on the Stage	Use Fit text; unlock or enlarge the affected box, reduce its type size, or shorten its text. Check overlap and contrast in Preview before saving.
JSON restore reports missing references	Make required media/templates available, or use a Chimera storyboard that includes dependencies.
AI generation does not yield a candidate	Check the visible error and ask the administrator to inspect provider/job configuration. The media form has no complete job monitor.

Screenshot and verification record

Changed controls were recaptured on 2026-10-14 from the actual local frontend and a fresh isolated demonstration workspace, using Chromium, a 1500-pixel-wide viewport, and Light appearance. Earlier captures are retained for unchanged controls; see the complete and refresh manifests for provenance. Images are stored in `docs/user-guide/images/` and contain demonstration data only. Proposal, generated-candidate, and enhancement-job examples were seeded locally to expose conditional controls. No paid generation or external submission was performed.

UI navigation, proposal acceptance, commenting/resolution, and sample assessment playback were exercised while capturing screens. Separate qualification records document automated regression, the synthetic live-AI quality pass, and operator acceptance of the SCORM 1.2 LMS fixture. This screenshot refresh itself does not establish broader provider quality or LMS compatibility. Screenshots should be refreshed whenever control labels or workflows change.

Capture details and refresh instructions: original manifest, 2026-10-14 refresh and maintainer instructions.